

July 27: Core 2 steps in

Intel's Core 2 architecture came just half a year after they had released the Core architecture. The new Core 2 CPUs were faster and ran cooler than anything previously made by either Intel or AMD. The popularity of Core 2 grew quickly, and is perhaps the CPU architecture that prompted the quick rise in dual-core and quad-core CPU popularity as well. Currently, you can go out and buy a four-core Core 2 CPU titled Core 2 Quads. Although Intel has already showcased poly-core CPUs (eight and more), the quad-CPU Core 2s are the fastest CPUs you can buy on the planet as of this writing.

October 9: The Google / YouTube thing

What do you do when you start an online service, then some upstart comes along, does things better and kills your service? You buy it, of course! Well, if you're Internet giant Google, you do. Since Google Video was kind of languishing, and YouTube had taken the world by storm, Google bought it over for \$1.65 billion (Rs 6,600 crore). The paranoid screamed "Big Brother", the majority didn't care less, and some companies saw dollar signs and promptly sued YouTube for copyrighted videos that had been on there for quite a while. Regardless, YouTube marches on as the fourth-most popular site on the entire Internet, and stockholders in Google and YouTube are laughing maniacally all the way to their respective banks.

November 14: And then, Microsoft's answer to the pod...

Microsoft released its much-hyped Zune portable media player to the world. The media hyped it so much that it was bound to fail; after all, all those iPeople didn't want to hear about Zune being the iPod killer—especially after shelling out hundreds of dollars on an Apple iPod! It doesn't really matter anyway, because despite all those Zunes being sold, there wasn't even a visible dent in iPod sales—so Apple couldn't be bothered.